# Joseph R. Loffredo


**Contact Information**

Department of Political Science
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*Last Updated: October 19, 2026*

## Education

**Massachusetts Institute of Technology** — Cambridge, MA

Ph.D., Political Science — Expected May 2027

Fields: American Politics, Models & Methods

Dissertation: *Essays on the Causes and Consequences of State Election Legislation*
Committee: Andrea Campbell, Devin Caughey, and Charles Stewart III (chair)

Graduate Student Researcher, *MIT Election Data and Science Lab*

**University of Rochester** — Rochester, NY

B.A., Political Science and Statistics (*magna cum laude*, Phi Beta Kappa) — 2019

Minor in Legal Studies

## Additional Training

Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program, *MIT Teaching + Learning Lab* — Fall 2024

## Appointments & Affiliations

**University of Rochester** — Rochester, NY

Visiting Scholar, Democracy Center — January 2026

## Research Interests

Political institutions, legislatures, public policy, state and local politics, election administration, large language models (LLMs), survey experiments

## Publications

4. **Loffredo, Joseph R.**, Michael Hankinson, and Asya Magazinnik. 2026. "Reform Drift: How Incumbent Protection Undermines Descriptive Representation in Local Government." *American Journal of Political Science*.

3. **Loffredo, Joseph R.** and Suyeol Yun. 2025. "Agent-Enhanced Large Language Models for Researching Political Institutions." *Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy* 6 (3-4). 277-300. DOI: 10.1561/113.00000125.

2. Kuriwaki, Shiro, Mason Reece, Samuel Baltz, Aleksandra Conevska, **Joseph R. Loffredo**, Can E. Mutlu, Taran Samarth, Kevin E. Acevedo Jetter, Zachary Djanogly Garai, Kate Murray, Shigeo Hirano, Jeffrey B. Lewis, James M. Snyder, Jr., and Charles Stewart, III. "Cast vote records: A database of ballots from the 2020 U.S. Election." *Scientific Data* 11 (1304). DOI: 10.1038/s41597-024-04017-1.

   - Winner, MIT Prize for Open Data
   - Dataset available on Harvard Dataverse: https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/PQQ3KV

1. Jaffe, Jacob, **Joseph R. Loffredo**, Samuel Baltz, Alejandro Flores, and Charles Stewart III. 2024. "Trust in the Count: Improving Voter Confidence with Post-Election Audits." *Public Opinion Quarterly* 88 (SI): 585–607. DOI: 10.1093/poq/nfae029.

   - Joint lead author
   - Winner, Best Poster at the 2023 Election Science, Research, and Administration Conference

## Under Review

Hankinson, Michael, **Joseph R. Loffredo**, and Asya Magazinnik. "Assessing District Elections as a Remedy in State Voting Rights Acts."

## Works in Progress

**Loffredo, Joseph R.** and Alejandro Flores. "Where We Vote: The Changing Landscape of Where Americans Cast Votes."

**Loffredo, Joseph R.** and Charles Stewart III. "State Confidence in Elections: Results, Practice, and Policy."

Hirano, Shigeo, **Joseph R. Loffredo**, Mason Reece, and James M. Snyder, Jr. "Trends in Nationalization of State and Local Elections: Evidence from Precinct Data."

**Loffredo, Joseph R.**, Jillian Andres Rothschild, and Alejandro Flores. "America Decides, Networks Project: How Voters Respond to Election Night Coverage."

**Loffredo, Joseph R**. "Election Officials as Policy Actors in State Legislatures."

**Loffredo, Joseph R**. "Contesting the Rules of the Game: Organized Groups in Election Policymaking."

## Research Assistance

Professor Charles Stewart III, Massachusetts Institute of Technology — 2022 – *present*
Professor Adam Berinsky, MIT Political Experiments Research Lab — 2025
Professor Asya Magazinnik, Massachusetts Institute of Technology — 2022

## Teaching

**Northeastern University**

Guest Lecturer, Comparative Democracies (POLS 4580) — Fall 2025
"Limits of the System: Bolstering Trust Under Electoral Federalism"

**Massachusetts Institute of Technology**

Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Research Methods I: Regression (17.800) — Fall 2024
(Professor: F. Daniel Hidalgo)
Instructor, Graduate Student Math Camp I — Fall 2025
Instructor, Introduction to LaTeX, MIT Political Methodology Lab Workshop — Fall 2024

**University of Rochester**

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Categorical Data Analysis (STT 218) — Fall 2019
(Professor: Joseph Ciminelli)
Teaching Assistant, Argument in Political Science (PSC 202W) — Fall 2018
(Professor: Gerald Gamm)

## Professional Experience

**CBS News** — November 2023 – *present*
Member, Election Data Desk

- Collaborated with academics and news analysts to develop real-time election forecasts for broadcast coverage; co-created R/Python pipeline for collecting precinct-level election results

**Civis Analytics**, Washington, DC — February 2020 – August 2021
Client Support Analyst

- Provided technical and strategic support to political and advocacy clients using proprietary data science platform; developed training curriculum for new and experienced users

**New York State Assembly**, Rochester, NY — February 2019 – May 2019
District Aide

## Awards

*MIT Prize for Open Data*, Masssachusetts Institute of Technology — 2024
*Best Poster*, Election Science, Research, and Administration Conference — 2023

*James D. McGill Memorial Prize*, University of Rochester 2020
Phi Beta Kappa, Iota of New York, University of Rochester 2020

## Invited Talks & Conference Presentations

Workshop, Democracy Center (Univ. of Rochester, Rochester, NY) 2026
American Elections 2024: Politics in Uncertain Times (Saint Anselm, Manchester, NH) 2025
Workshop, Center for Democracy & Civic Engagement (Univ. of Maryland, College Park, MD) 2025
AI and the Study of Political Institutions Conference (USC, Los Angeles, CA) 2024
Symposium on the Politics of Immigration, Race, and Ethnicity (Yale, New Haven, CT) 2023

American Political Science Association 2023, 2024, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association 2024, 2025, 2026
Southern Political Science Association 2023, 2024, 2026
Election Science, Research, and Administration Conference 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
PolMeth Conference of the Society for Political Methodology 2026
State Politics and Policy Conference 2025, 2026

## Service

**Referee:**
*American Journal of Political Science* (2)
*Electoral Studies* (2)
*Politics and Governance* (1)

**Conference Panel Chair/Discussant**:
Election Science CwC, Southern Political Science Association 2026
Midwest Political Science Association 2024, 2026

**Department**:
Member, American Politics Junior Faculty Search Committee 2025
Co-President, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council 2024-2025
Social Co-Chair, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council 2023-2024
MIT Political Science Application Mentorship Program (PSAMP) 2024-2025

## Membership

American Political Science Association
Midwest Political Science Association
Southern Political Science Association

## Programming

Proficient in: R, Python, Tableau, Qualtrics, LaTeX, GIS

## References

**Charles Stewart III**
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Massachusetts Institute of Technology
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**Asya Magazinnik**
Department of Social Data Science
Hertie School
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**Andrea Campbell**
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**Devin Caughey**
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